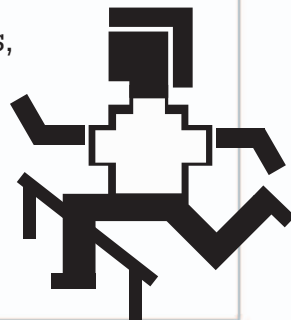


GAME DEVELOPER



JOB DESCRIPTION

A game developer produces games for different platforms, including personal computers (PCs), game consoles, smartphones, tablets, and websites. As a game developer, you could be involved in a variety of roles, from developing the game's initial concept or writing the code for it, to creating audio and video files, to writing instructions for animators and other members of their team.



SALARY

Junior developer ★★★★★

Lead developer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Massive expansion in recent years, and set to grow further • Many freelance contracts available • Smaller companies with fewer than 50 employees common

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Computer science • Graphics • 3-D design • Animation and illustration • Gaming • Coding • Mathematics • Physics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in computer science or a media-related discipline is useful, although not required, for becoming a developer.



LIFESTYLE Teams are close-knit and may work extra hours together to prepare a new game for an upcoming launch date.



LOCATION Game developers work mainly on a computer in an office. The atmosphere is informal and creative, with people from many disciplines.



THE REALITIES Entry to the field is highly competitive. Strict deadlines drive the work, and spending long periods on a computer can be tiring.

CAREER PATHS

There is no formal career structure for game developers. Progress depends largely on which path is taken—for example, focusing on programming graphics or the user interface. In this young and dynamic industry, success depends on performance, and on the sales and critical acclaim of the games.

PLAY TESTER You may be able to find work with a gaming company testing their products for playability and flaws (bugs). This can provide an entry route into the industry.



GRADUATE Having a degree in computer science gives you the best chance of employment. Some colleges offer specialty game-programming courses or modules.

